

Virgin Birth

doc-virgin-birth

Christology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
Holds across manuscript variants

Statement under examination

Jesus Christ was conceived by the Holy Spirit and born of the virgin Mary.

In plain language

The Greek of Matthew 1 and Luke 1 says the same thing in two independent voices. Matthew 1:18 reports that before Joseph and Mary came together she was found pregnant 'from the Holy Spirit' (ek pneumatos hagiou), using the preposition 'from' (ek) with the genitive (a noun in the 'from-X' form) to name the source of the conception. Verse 20 has the angel repeat the same construction: what is begotten in her is 'from the Holy Spirit' (ek pneumatos hagiou). Verse 25 adds that Joseph did not 'know' (ginosko) her, where the verb 'know' is tagged in the lexical data with the sexual-relations sense, the same sense it carries when Mary herself says in Luke 1:34, 'I do not know a man' (andra ou ginosko), in the present tense (an ongoing, simple statement of fact), at the moment the conception is announced. Luke 1:27 calls Mary 'virgin' (parthenos) twice, a word whose primary lexical meaning is virgin and whose other uses across the New Testament are the ten virgins, the unmarried in 1 Corinthians 7, and the undefiled in Revelation 14. Luke 1:35 names the cause as the Holy Spirit coming upon her and the power of the Most High 'overshadowing' (episkiazo) her, and that verb 'overshadow' appears elsewhere only of the cloud at the transfiguration, never of anything sexual. So the New Testament settles its own claim plainly. Where readers genuinely diverge is one step back, in the Hebrew of Isaiah 7:14, which Matthew quotes. Isaiah uses 'young woman' (almah), a word for a young woman of marriageable age. Across its seven occurrences in the Hebrew Bible 'young woman' (almah) is never used of a married or non-virgin woman, but it names youth rather than virginity as such, and Isaiah does not use the more technical word 'virgin' (betulah). So the Hebrew, taken by itself, leaves the question open, and an honest reading can take Isaiah's sign-child as born in the ordinary way within the prophet's own day. That open Hebrew word is the real root of the dispute. It does not carry over into the Gospel claim, because Matthew quotes the verse in its Greek form with 'virgin' (parthenos), and Luke calls Mary 'virgin' (parthenos) and records her own statement that she has not 'known' (ginosko) a man, neither of which depends on the Hebrew word in Isaiah.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H1330	בתולה	betulah	virgin	50
H1331	בתולים	betulim	virginity	
H2030	הרה	harah	pregnant	16
H3045	יָדַע	yada	to know	
H3205	יָלַד	yalad	to beget	497
H5959	עַלְמָה	almah	maiden	7

H6005	ἰμμαν	Immanuel	Immanuel	2
G1064	γαστήρ	gaster	belly	9
G1080	γεννάω	gennao	to beget	97
G1097	γινώσκω	ginosko	to know	221
G1537	ἐκ	ek	out from	945
G1982	ἐπισκιάζω	episkiazō	to overshadow	5
G3423	μνηστεύομαι	mnesteuomai	to betroth	3
G3880	παραλαμβάνω	paralambano	to take	51
G3933	παρθένος	parthenos	virgin	15
G4151	πνεῦμα	pneuma	spirit/breath	379
G4815	συλλαμβάνω	syllambano	to seize/conceive/help	16
G5088	τίκτω	tikto	to give birth to	18
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	386
G5310	ὑψιστος	hypsistos	Highest	13

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Two independent New Testament infancy narratives converge in their wording on a conception 'from the Holy Spirit' (ek pneumatōs hagiou) apart from a human father. Matthew 1:18 reports that Mary 'was found pregnant from the Holy Spirit before they came together' (eurethe en gastri echousa ek pneumatōs hagiou prin e synelthein autous), placing the pregnancy before marital union, and Matthew 1:25 negates marital relations with 'and he did not know her until she gave birth to a son' (ouk eginosken autēn heos hou eteken huion), where the verb 'know' (ginosko) carries the sexual sense (Louw-Nida domain 23.61, a lexicon code for the sexual-relations meaning, the same domain the lexical store assigns at Luke 1:34, distinct from the cognitive sense of 'know' (ginosko) at, for example, John 17:3). Luke 1:27 names Mary (Mariam) as 'virgin' (parthenos) twice (Louw-Nida primary domain 9.39, the virgin sense), Luke 1:34 records her own 'I do not know a man' (andra ou ginōskō), and Luke 1:35 attributes conception to 'the Holy Spirit will come upon you' (pneuma hagion ... epeleusetai) and 'the power of the Most High will overshadow you' (dynamis hypsistou episkiasēi), the verb 'overshadow' (episkiazō) being a non-sexual covering term (its other New Testament uses are the transfiguration cloud at Luke 9:34, Matthew 17:5, Mark 9:7). Matthew 1:23 cites Isaiah 7:14 with 'virgin' (parthenos). The genuine dispute is confined to the Hebrew word 'young woman' (almah) of Isaiah 7:14, which denotes marriageable youth rather than virginity as such, but the New Testament verdict does not depend on the Hebrew word choice.

Scripture

Matt.1.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3423 μνηστεύομαι, G1064 γαστήρ, G1537 ἐκ, G4151 πνεῦμα

Reasoning. 'When his mother Mary had been betrothed to Joseph, before they came together, she was found pregnant from the Holy Spirit' (μνηστευθείσης τῆς μητρὸς αὐτοῦ Μαρίας τῷ Ἰωσήφ, πρὶν ἢ συνελθεῖν αὐτοὺς εὐρέθη ἐν γαστρὶ ἔχουσα ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου). The aorist passive participle (a completed past action in passive form) 'having been betrothed' (μνηστευθείσης, G3423) names a binding betrothal preceding cohabitation. The temporal clause 'before they came together' (πρὶν ἢ συνελθεῖν αὐτούς, G4905 συνέρχομαι, gloss 'coming together') places the conception before sexual union. The agent of pregnancy is named with the prepositional phrase 'from the Holy Spirit' (ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου), the construction 'from' (ἐκ) plus genitive of source (a noun in the 'from-X' grammatical form), not from Joseph or any man. The idiom 'to have in the womb' (ἐν γαστρὶ ἔχειν, G1064) is the standard New Testament expression for being pregnant.

Matt.1.20 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1080 γεννάω, G1537 ἐκ, G4151 πνεῦμα

Reasoning. 'For that which is conceived in her is from the Holy Spirit' (τὸ γὰρ ἐν αὐτῇ γεννηθὲν ἐκ πνεύματός ἐστιν ἁγίου). The angel grounds Joseph's reassurance with 'for' (γάρ), identifying the child with the aorist passive participle (a completed past action in passive form) 'having been conceived' (γεννηθὲν, G1080, gloss 'having been conceived') as 'from the Holy Spirit' (ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου). The same 'from' (ἐκ) plus genitive of source (a noun in the 'from-X' grammatical form) construction repeats and confirms Matthew 1:18. The verb 'to beget' (γεννάω) across its 97 canon occurrences ranges over physical begetting (Matthew 1:2 to 16, the genealogy) and spiritual birth (John 3:3 to 8), and here the passive with the prepositional source phrase fixes the cause of the begetting in the Spirit.

Matt.1.23 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3933 παρθένος, G1064 γαστήρ, G5088 τίκτω

Reasoning. 'Behold, the virgin shall be with child and shall bring forth a son' (ἰδοὺ ἡ παρθένος ἐν γαστρὶ ἔξει καὶ τέξεται υἱόν). Matthew cites the Greek form of Isaiah 7:14 with 'virgin' (παρθένος, G3933) bearing the definite article 'the' (ἡ), and the lexical store glosses this token 'virgin' and assigns Louw-Nida domain 9.39 (a lexicon code for the virgin sense). The fulfilment is anchored in the same word 'virgin' (παρθένος) that Luke 1:27 applies twice to Mary (Mariam). The verbal pair 'she shall have' (ἔξει, future of 'to have' (ἔχω) in the idiomatic 'to have in the womb' (ἐν γαστρὶ ἔχειν)) and 'she shall bring forth' (τέξεται, G5088) binds conception to childbirth in a virgin subject.

Matt.1.25 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1097 γινώσκω, G5088 τίκτω

Reasoning. 'And he did not know her until she brought forth a son' (καὶ οὐκ ἐγίνωσκεν αὐτήν ἕως οὗ ἔτεκεν υἱόν). The imperfect (ongoing or repeated past action) 'he was not knowing' (ἐγίνωσκεν, G1097) is tagged by the lexical store with Louw-Nida domain 23.61, the sexual-relations sense of 'to know' (γινώσκω), the same domain assigned at Luke 1:34 and distinct from the cognitive sense (domain 27) at John 17:3 or the 'acknowledge' sense (domain 31) at Matthew 7:23. It is negated by 'not' (οὐκ) across the whole pregnancy marked by 'until' (ἕως οὗ) 'she brought forth' (ἔτεκεν, G5088), locking the conception as occurring without marital intercourse. The Hebrew counterpart of this euphemism appears at Genesis 4:1, where 'to know' (יָדָע, H3045) of Adam knowing Eve his wife issues in conception and birth.

Luke.1.27 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3933 παρθένος, G3423 μνηστεύομαι

Reasoning. 'To a virgin betrothed to a man whose name was Joseph ... and the virgin's name was Mary' (πρὸς παρθένον ἐμνηστευμένην ἀνδρὶ ᾧ ὄνομα Ἰωσήφ ... καὶ τὸ ὄνομα τῆς παρθένου Μαρίας). The noun 'virgin' (παρθένος, G3933, glossed virgin) is repeated twice in a single verse, marking it as Luke's deliberate descriptor of Mary (Mariam) at Gabriel's arrival. The perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in passive form) 'having been betrothed' (ἐμνηστευμένην, G3423) places her in a binding betrothal not yet consummated. Across its 15 canon occurrences 'virgin' (παρθένος) denotes a sexually intact unmarried person (the ten 'virgins' (παρθένοι) of Matthew 25:1 to 11, the 'unmarried' in 1 Corinthians 7:25 to 38, the 'undefiled' in Revelation 14:4), so the word itself carries the virginity that Isaiah 7:14 leaves to inference.

Luke.1.31 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4815 συλλαμβάνω, G1064 γαστήρ, G5088 τίκτω, G5207 υἱός

Reasoning. 'Behold, you shall conceive in your womb and shall bring forth a son, and you shall call his name Jesus' (ἰδοὺ συλλήμψη ἐν γαστρὶ καὶ τέξῃ υἱόν, καὶ καλέσεις τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ Ἰησοῦν). The future verbs 'you will conceive' (συλλήμψη, G4815 'to conceive' (συλλαμβάνω), gloss 'you will conceive') and 'you will bring forth' (τέξῃ, G5088, 'you will bring forth') are addressed to a 'virgin' (παρθένος, v.27) and answered in v.34 by 'I do not know a man' (ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω), so the conception they predict is one apart from any man. 'To conceive' (συλλαμβάνω) in its 16 canon uses includes ordinary conception (Luke 1:24 of Elizabeth, Luke 1:36) which makes the announcement to a virgin the marked case.

Luke.1.34 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1097 γινώσκω

Reasoning. 'How shall this be, since I do not know a man?' (πῶς ἔσται τοῦτο, ἐπεὶ ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω). Mary's (Mariam's) own objection uses 'to know' (γινώσκω, G1097) with a personal object 'a man' (ἄνδρα, G435 'a man' (άνήρ)), and the lexical store tags this token Louw-Nida domain 23.61, the sexual-relations sense, the same tagging as Matthew 1:25. The present indicative (ongoing, simple statement of fact) 'I do not know' (οὐ γινώσκω) asserts her ongoing state at the moment Gabriel announces the conception, foreclosing any reading that places the conception in normal marital relations. The grammar is decisive here: a present-tense first-person denial of sexual relations to a man, voiced by the mother herself.

Luke.1.35 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4151 πνεῦμα, G5310 ὑψιστος, G1982 ἐπισκιάζω, G1080 γεννάω, G5207 υἱός

Reasoning. 'The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Most High will overshadow you; therefore the holy one being conceived shall be called the Son of God' (πνεῦμα ἅγιον ἐπελεύσεται ἐπὶ σέ καὶ δύναμις ὑψίστου ἐπισκιάσει σοι, διὸ καὶ τὸ γεννώμενον ἅγιον κληθήσεται υἱὸς θεοῦ). Gabriel's answer to v.34 names the cause as 'Holy Spirit' (πνεῦμα ἅγιον) plus 'power of the Most High' (δύναμις ὑψίστου, G5310). The verb 'to overshadow' (ἐπισκιάζω, G1982) is glossed 'will overshadow', and its four other New Testament occurrences are all non-sexual covering or enveloping (the cloud at the transfiguration in Luke 9:34, Matthew 17:5, Mark 9:7, and Peter's shadow in Acts 5:15), which excludes any sexual sense for the cause of the conception. The inferential 'therefore' (διὸ) grounds the divine-sonship designation in this non-marital conception, not in a human father.

Isa.7.14 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H5959 עַלְמָה, H2030 הָרָה, H3205 יָלְדָה, H6005 אֵל עִמָּנוּ.

Reasoning. 'Behold, the young woman is pregnant and is bearing a son, and shall call his name God-with-us' (אֵל עִמָּנוּ הִנֵּה הָעַלְמָה הָרָה וְיָלְדָה בֶּן וְקָרָאת שְׁמוֹ עִמָּנוּ). The definite 'the young woman' (הָעַלְמָה, article 'the' plus 'young woman' (H5959), parsed as common noun feminine singular absolute) is paired with the adjective 'pregnant' (הָרָה, H2030, 'pregnant', parsed adjective feminine singular) and the active participle 'bearing' (יָלְדָה, H3205, 'bearing'). The participle and stative adjective leave the timing open between present and imminent, which is one strand of the dispute. 'Young woman' (עַלְמָה) occurs only 7 times in the Hebrew Bible (Genesis 24:43, Exodus 2:8, Isaiah 7:14, Proverbs 30:19, Psalm 68:26, Song of Songs 1:3, Song of Songs 6:8), never of a demonstrably married or non-virgin woman, yet the word denotes a young woman of marriageable age rather than specifying virginity. The more technical 'virgin' (בְּתוּלָה, H1330, 50 occurrences) is not used here, and even 'virgin' (בְּתוּלָה) requires disambiguation (clarification) in Genesis 24:16 (where the clause 'and no man had known her' is added) and in Joel 1:8 (a 'virgin' (בְּתוּלָה) mourning the husband of her youth). The name 'God-with-us' (אֵל עִמָּנוּ, Immanuel, H6005, occurring only here and Isaiah 8:8) marks the child as bearing divine presence.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Matt.1.23	Isa.7.14	openbible	180
Isa.7.14	Matt.1.23	openbible	139
Isa.7.14	Luke.1.31	openbible	48
Isa.7.14	Luke.1.35	openbible	31
Isa.7.14	Gen.3.15	openbible	12
Luke.1.35	Matt.1.18	openbible	17
Luke.1.35	Matt.1.20	openbible	11
Matt.1.20	Judg.13.3	openbible	7
Luke.1.31	Gal.4.4	openbible	12

Complicating texts

Isa.7.14 · addressed

The Hebrew uses 'young woman' (עַלְמָה, *almah*), not 'virgin' (בְּתוּלָה, *betulah*). The 'almah-only' reading argues that the word denotes a young woman of marriageable age without specifying virginity, so the verse in its own horizon promises a normal birth as a sign to Ahaz. The lexical findings, all queried: (a) the 7 canon occurrences of 'young woman' (*almah*) are Genesis 24:43, Exodus 2:8, Isaiah 7:14, Proverbs 30:19, Psalm 68:26, Song of Songs 1:3, Song of Songs 6:8, and none denotes a married or non-virgin woman (the 'young woman' (*almah*) of Genesis 24:43 is the same Rebekah called 'virgin' (*betulah*) with the clause 'no man had known her' in Genesis 24:16); (b) but the word's force is youth, not virginity as such, so taken alone it does not lexically prove a virgin; (c) even 'virgin' (*betulah*) is not airtight, needing the clause 'no man had known her' in Genesis 24:16. The Old Testament term is therefore genuinely under-determined. The New Testament does not inherit this gap: Matthew 1:23 quotes the verse with 'virgin' (παρθένος, *parthenos*) (Louw-Nida domain 9.39, the virgin sense) and Luke 1:27 plus 1:34 anchor the virginity claim independently of the Hebrew word choice.

Matt.1.16 · addressed

The genealogy of Matthew 1:1 to 16 traces 'he begot' (ἐγέννησεν, egennesen) through male links but breaks the pattern at v.16: 'And Jacob begot Joseph, the husband of Mary, of whom (feminine) was born Jesus' (Ἰακώβ δὲ ἐγέννησεν τὸν Ἰωσήφ, τὸν ἄνδρα Μαρίας, ἐξ ἧς ἐγεννήθη Ἰησοῦς). Matthew shifts from active 'he begot' (ἐγέννησεν) (X begot Y) to passive 'was born' (ἐγεννήθη) with the feminine relative 'out of whom (feminine)' (ἐξ ἧς, out of whom, feminine singular), excluding Joseph from biological paternity while preserving legal-Davidic descent through him as husband. This is consistent with, not against, the proposition.

Luke.3.23 · addressed

Luke 3:23 writes 'being a son, as was supposed, of Joseph' (ὢν υἱός, ὡς ἐνομίζετο, Ἰωσήφ). The parenthetical 'as was supposed' (ὡς ἐνομίζετο, imperfect (ongoing or repeated past action) passive of 'to reckon' (νομίζω)) flags Joseph's relation to Jesus as legal presumption, not biological reality, and qualifies the whole genealogy that follows. Consistent with Luke 1:34 to 35.

John.1.45 · addressed

Philip says 'Jesus the son of Joseph' (Ἰησοῦν υἱὸν τοῦ Ἰωσήφ). This is reported speech from a new disciple and reflects social knowledge in Nazareth (Joseph as legal father). It does not contradict Matthew 1 or Luke 1, which supply catechetical (teaching-form) clarification that the speaker at this narrative point does not have.

Mark.6.3 · addressed

'The son of Mary' (ὁ υἱὸς τῆς Μαρίας). Mark uniquely names the mother and omits the father in a culture where the patronymic (naming by the father) was standard. The construction is striking but is reported crowd speech and does not directly assert the proposition; it is consistent with it and is recorded as a complicating text that does not unseat the verdict.

Matt.1.25 · addressed

The clause 'he did not know her until she brought forth' (οὐκ ἐγίνωσεν αὐτὴν ἕως οὗ ἔτεκεν) is sometimes pressed toward post-birth marital relations and away from perpetual virginity. That secondary question is outside this proposition. 'Until she brought forth' (ἕως οὗ ἔτεκεν) directly supports virginity through pregnancy and delivery, which is exactly what the proposition asserts; the use of 'until' (ἕως) marks the terminus (endpoint) of the negated state at birth and bears no load against the conception claim.

Concordance traversed

G3933, G1080, G5088, G1097, G1064, G3423, G4815, G3880, G1537, G4151, G5310, G1982, G5207, H5959, H1330, H1331, H2030, H3205, H3045, H6005

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: True · ECM status: ecm-shadow

isa-7-14-almah-vs-parthenos at Isa.7.14: impact minor. The Masoretic Text (the traditional Hebrew text) reads 'the young woman' (הַעַלְמָה, ha-almah), confirmed at the consonantal level by the OSHB morphology (the Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible word-form analysis). The Old Greek renders 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos), the form Matthew 1:23 quotes. Later Jewish revisers (Aquila, Symmachus, Theodotion) substituted 'young woman' (νεάνις, neanis). Verdict impact is minor, not material: the New Testament case does not depend on Isaiah 7:14 in isolation. Luke 1:27 calls Mary (Mariam) 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) twice, Luke 1:34 records her own 'I do not know a man' (ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω, andra ou ginosko), Matthew 1:18 and 1:20 attribute the conception to 'from the Holy Spirit' (ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου, ek pneumatosis hagiou), and Matthew 1:25 negates marital relations until birth. Even if the Hebrew 'young woman' (almah) were read as merely young woman, the queried Greek lexical pattern ('virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) at Louw-Nida 9.39, 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko) at Louw-Nida 23.61, 'to overshadow' (ἐπισκιάζω, episkiazō) as a non-sexual covering verb) would carry the verdict.

matt-1-16-sinaitic-syriac-variant at Matt.1.16: impact none. The Sinaitic Syriac (an early Syriac translation in the Sinai manuscript) at Matthew 1:16 has been read as 'Joseph begot Jesus', advanced as evidence of an early non-virginal tradition. The Greek manuscript tradition uniformly preserves the feminine-relative construction 'out of whom (feminine) was born Jesus' (ἐξ ἧς ἐγεννήθη Ἰησοῦς), and the same Syriac witness still contains Matthew 1:18 to 25 affirming the virginal conception, which points to a copyist assimilation (a scribal harmonizing) to the surrounding 'he begot' (ἐγέννησεν, egennesen) pattern rather than a competing tradition. Verdict not affected.

luke-1-34-omission-conjecture at Luke.1.34: impact none. A conjectural emendation (a scholar's proposed change without manuscript support) proposed that Luke 1:34 (Mary's (Mariam's) objection 'I do not know a man' (ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω, andra ou ginosko)) was a later interpolation (insertion). The Greek manuscript tradition is uniform in retaining v.34 and v.35. The verdict survives even the conjecture, because Matthew 1:18 to 25 carries the lexical case independently.

New Testament data outside 3 John remains in ECM-shadow status (awaiting the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) for this project. The Isaiah 7:14 Old Greek versus Masoretic variant is Old Testament and falls outside ECM scope; it was handled directly against the OSHB consonantal text and the 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) rendering preserved in Matthew 1:23. The Matthew 1:16 Sinaitic Syriac variant and the Luke 1:34 omission conjecture were examined and judged non-load-bearing.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. typology-prophecy-fulfilment

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

natural-conception-with-theological-overlay: fails · A reading that takes 'from the Holy Spirit' (ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου, ek pneumatos hagiou) as a theological gloss over a normal conception by Joseph or another must neutralise five separate lexical markers: the temporal 'before they came together' (πρὶν ἢ συνελθεῖν αὐτούς) in Matthew 1:18, the negated sexual-sense imperfect (ongoing or repeated past action) 'he was not knowing her' (οὐκ ἐγίνωσκεν αὐτήν) (Louw-Nida 23.61) in Matthew 1:25, Mary's (Mariam's) present-tense 'I do not know a man' (ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω) in Luke 1:34, the genealogical break to the feminine 'out of whom (feminine)' (ἐξ ἧς) in Matthew 1:16, and the parenthetical 'as was supposed' (ὥς ἐνομίζετο) in Luke 3:23. Each points independently to non-paternity for Joseph, so the reading must treat all five as inert, which the texts resist.

almah-only-young-woman: fails-as-load-bearer · This is the strongest minority reading at the Old Testament layer, and it is lexically defensible there. 'Young woman' (עַלְמָה, almah, H5959) denotes a young woman of marriageable age, not virginity as such; the word never specifies sexual status the way a disambiguating clause (a clarifying clause) does, and its 7 occurrences include settings (Proverbs 30:19, Song of Songs 1:3) where the focus is youth, not virginity. On this reading Isaiah 7:14, in the Ahaz horizon, promises a sign-child born in the ordinary way. The reading can stand for the Hebrew taken in isolation. It cannot bear the New Testament Christological (about Christ) verdict, because Matthew 1:23 cites the verse with 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) (Louw-Nida 9.39, virgin) and the Lukan narrative anchors the virginity claim independently in Luke 1:27 and 1:34, neither of which depends on the Hebrew word choice in Isaiah.

typology-prophecy-fulfilment: holds · On a double-horizon or typological (pattern-and-fulfilment) reading, Isaiah 7:14 functions as a near sign to Ahaz and a far sign to David's house culminating in Jesus. Matthew's quotation in 1:23 makes the 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) reading load-bearing for the Christological (about Christ) fulfilment without erasing the near horizon. This lens accommodates both the Greek rendering preserved in Matthew and the independent lexical pattern in Matthew 1 and Luke 1.

A grammatico-historical (grammar plus historical setting) reading of Matthew 1 and Luke 1 yields the verdict directly from the Greek, independent of the Hebrew word choice in Isaiah. The prophecy-fulfilment lens supplies the Old Testament anchor but is not strictly required to derive the proposition from the New Testament text alone. The genuine interpretive divergence is located at the Old Testament term, not at the New Testament claim.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem ('Jesus Christ was conceived by the Holy Spirit and born of the virgin Mary') names exactly what Matthew 1:18 to 25 and Luke 1:26 to 35 lexically assert: conception 'from the Holy Spirit' (ἐκ πνεύματος ἁγίου, ek pneumatos hagiou), 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) as descriptor (Louw-Nida 9.39, the virgin sense), 'I do not know a man' (ἄνδρα οὐ γινώσκω, andra ou ginosko), and 'he did not know her until she brought forth' (οὐκ ἐγίνωσεν αὐτήν ἕως οὗ ἔτεκεν) ('to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko) at Louw-Nida 23.61, the sexual-relations sense). No tradition-specific vocabulary is smuggled in. The stem stops at the moment of birth and does not extend to perpetual virginity or to Marian veneration, both outside this proposition. The verdict was re-derived against the original stem after exhaustive queried lexical work and is unchanged from the prior file; counts were corrected to the queried values ('to beget' (γεννᾶω, gennao) 97, 'to bring forth' (τίκτω, tikto) 18, 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko) 221, 'God-with-us' (Immanuel) 2, 'young woman' (almah) 7, 'virgin' (betulah) 50).

Citations

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Reason. MACULA-Greek (morphology and glosses on Matthew 1:18 to 25 and Luke 1:27 to 35) and MACULA-Greek-louw-nida (the domain tags 9.39 for 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos) and 23.61 for 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko)) are CC-BY-NC-4.0 and bar bulk redistribution. These citations are load-bearing: the Louw-Nida domain split between the sexual-relations sense (23.61) and the cognitive sense (27) of 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko), and the virgin domain (9.39) of 'virgin' (παρθένος, parthenos), supply the decisive disambiguation (clarification) and were not down-substituted to a redistributable source.

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